Kitsune — News Desk Briefing
Prepared: 3/13/2026, 10:48:31 PM

Kitsune's Digest

Greetings. The ink flows like a river through the cedar forest, carrying whispers of a world in flux. I have smoothed the parchment to record the shifting shadows of the day. Here is the state of the scroll as it stands.

MAIN HEADLINES

• US forces bomb Kharg Island, striking the core of Iran's oil economy.
• President Trump claims the US is "way ahead of schedule" in the conflict with Iran.
• TikTok investors are reportedly set to pay a $10 billion fee to the Trump administration.
• A federal judge temporarily blocks the administration's demand for university student race data.
• Eight individuals are convicted in a Texas ICE facility shooting linked to "antifa."
• Team USA and the Dominican Republic advance to the World Baseball Classic semifinals.
• Oil prices have risen 40% since the start of the US-Iran war.
• A chemical smell at a control center grounds flights in Washington and Baltimore.
• Los Angeles officials seek an investigation into the LA28 Olympics chief over Epstein ties.
• President Zelensky slams the US decision to drop oil sanctions against Putin.
• A cream cheese recall is upgraded to a high-risk warning of "serious adverse health consequences."
• A NJ-based shipping company confirms one crew member killed in an Iranian attack on a tanker.

THEMES

• Rapid escalation of kinetic and economic warfare between the United States and Iran.
• Legal and administrative friction regarding Trump administration domestic and educational policies.
• Heightened domestic security concerns following attacks in Michigan, Virginia, and New York.
• The intersection of international conflict and the volatility of global energy markets.

CATEGORIES

USA
• A federal judge nixed two subpoenas against Federal Reserve Chair Jerome Powell.
• Over 900 children have reportedly been held in ICE custody past the 20-day legal limit.

• JD Vance faces criticism for claiming Kristi Noem's DHS departure was an "opportunity" rather than a firing.
• Staten Island residents report a mysterious "rotten egg" smell causing nausea and eye irritation.
• Trump clears the Oklahoma Senate path for a candidate with a formal endorsement.
• Charges were dropped against Georgia teens involved in a prank that led to a teacher's death.

WORLD
• Analysts suggest the US threat of "no quarter" for Iran may violate international law.
• Xi Jinping's long-running corruption purge in China continues to target millions of officials.
• The Republic of Congo prepares for an upcoming election with high stakes for regional stability.
• A projectile exploded in Israel's Negev region; no immediate casualties were detailed.
• The family of the Michigan synagogue attack suspect was reportedly killed in a Lebanon airstrike.

TECH
• An offshore wind project targeted by the administration has begun sending power to the New England grid.
• TikTok investors' $10 billion fee to the US government marks a major shift in the platform's domestic standing.

ENTERTAINMENT
• North West, 12, draws social media backlash for a "daring" manicure featuring spikes and piercings.
• The "Baywatch" reboot cast begins a "boot camp" at Venice Beach ahead of filming.
• Jessie Buckley's career trajectory from reality TV to Oscar history is highlighted by critics.
• The New York Academy of Art is giving away funds previously donated by Jeffrey Epstein.

SPORTS
• Team USA survives a close game against Canada to secure a WBC semifinal spot.
• Austin Wells hits a walk-off mercy rule home run to send the Dominican Republic to the semifinals.
• Mark DeRosa defends his management of Team USA amid mounting criticism.
• Lindsey Vonn reports significant progress in injury recovery weeks after an Olympic crash.
• The New York Knicks narrowly defeated the Indiana Pacers in a shorthanded victory.

OTHER
• The closure of Noma and René Redzepi's departure continues to impact the global dining industry.

• Vincent's Clam Bar is noted for providing meals to New York's March Madness-bound basketball teams.

WATCHLIST / UNKNOWN

• **Strait of Hormuz:** Whether Iran will attempt to close the vital waterway in response to Kharg Island strikes.
• **Aviation Safety:** The specific chemical source that caused the ground stop at Washington and Baltimore airports.
• **WBC Semifinals:** The upcoming matchup between Team USA and the Dominican Republic.
• **Staten Island Stench:** Investigation into the source of the "rotten egg" smell remains unresolved.
• **Gubernatorial Debate:** Response from USC and ABC7 regarding criticism over the exclusion of candidates of color.

SOURCES
System source stats:
• Feeds in profile: 10
• Headlines scanned: 185
• Digest items passed to model: 60
• Unique domains in digest items: 9

Sources used (deduped by domain):
• New York Post (nypost.com) — 19
  • Example: Mark DeRosa defends his job amid mounting WBC criticism: 'Underlying passion'
  • Example: NJ-based shipping company slams Iran's 'barbaric attack' on oil tanker that killed 1 crew member
• NYT (nytimes.com) — 12
  • Example: TikTok Investors Set to Pay $10 Billion Fee to Trump Administration
  • Example: With Endorsement, Trump Clears Oklahoma Senate Path
• The Independent World (independent.co.uk) — 11
  • Example: Trump tells Jake Paul what it was like to get shot at Butler rally: 'It was a bloody mess'
  • Example: Ukraine-Russia war latest: Zelensky slams Trump decision to drop Putin oil sanctions as bad for peace
• Al Jazeera (aljazeera.com) — 7
  • Example: Trump claims US 'way ahead of schedule' in Iran war
  • Example: Projectile falls, explodes in Israel's Negev
• BBC News (bbc.com) — 5
  • Example: Charges dropped against Georgia teens whose teacher died during toilet

paper prank
  • Example: Los Angeles asks for investigation into LA28 Olympics chief over Epstein ties
• New York Post (pagesix.com) — 2
  • Example: North West, 12, debuts daring new manicure with spikes, piercings after backlash
• World News (news.sky.com) — 2
  • Example: 'Trump is doing a favour for humanity': Hopes and fears of LA's Iranian community
  • Example: Reality TV to Oscars history: The rise and rise of Jessie Buckley
• World (washingtonpost.com) — 1
  • Example: Trump says U.S. bombed Kharg Island, striking core of Iran’s oil economy
• World & Nation (latimes.com) — 1
  • Example: USC and ABC7 criticized for exclusion of all candidates of color in upcoming gubernatorial debate

Feed titles encountered (raw RSS, debug):
• New York Post
• Al Jazeera – Breaking News, World News and Video from Al Jazeera
• The Independent World
• BBC News
• NYT > Top Stories
• World
• World & Nation
• World News - Breaking international news and headlines | Sky News